

Request Number: 2026-ICFO-24202
Submission Date: 4/17/2026
Agency: Department of Homeland Security
Component: US Immigrations & Customs Enforcement
Processing Track: Simple
Status: Awaiting Agency Review
Request Description:

Pursuant to the Freedom of Information Act, 5 U.S.C. § 552, I request access to records related to the valuation, appraisal, and price determination of real properties acquired by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) and/or the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) for detention, processing, or enforcement-related use.

This request pertains to the following properties:

- 16220 Wright Road, Williamsport, MD
- 1365 E Hightower Trail, Social Circle, GA
- 3613 Atlanta Highway, Flowery Branch, GA
- 1465-1485 Eastwind Ave, Socorro, TX
- 13290 W Sweetwater Ave, Surprise, AZ
- 7525 Cogswell St, Romulus, MI
- 3501 Mountain Road, Hamburg, PA
- 1879 Route 46, Roxbury, NJ
- 50 Rausch Creek Road, Tremont, PA
- 542 SE Loop 410, San Antonio, TX
- 6020 W 300 S, Salt Lake City, UT

For each property, I request records sufficient to show:

- Appraised value and any broker opinions of value
- Internal valuation analyses or memoranda
- Final purchase price and justification for that price
- Comparisons between appraised value and purchase price
- Market analyses or comparable property studies used in valuation
- Communications regarding valuation or price negotiation, including correspondence with brokers, appraisers, contractors, or property owners
- Identification of any contractors or third parties involved in valuation or acquisition
- Contracts, task orders, or statements of work related to real estate acquisition or valuation services

- Policies, guidance, or standard operating procedures governing real estate valuation and acquisition for detention or enforcement purposes

This request includes, but is not limited to, emails, memoranda, reports, appraisals, contracts, and supporting documentation. I request that all records be provided in electronic format where available.

Fee Waiver Status: Pending Decision

Fee Waiver Justification:

I request a waiver of all fees as this request is made in the public interest and is not for commercial use. The requested records concern federal government spending and acquisition practices related to immigration detention infrastructure, an issue that is the subject of active public debate, litigation, and congressional oversight. Specifically, this request seeks to clarify how DHS and ICE determine valuation and purchase prices for large-scale real estate acquisitions, including whether those prices align with independent appraisals and prevailing market benchmarks.

This information is not meaningfully available through existing public sources such as contract summaries or spending databases, which do not disclose underlying valuation methods, appraisal comparisons, or internal price justifications. Disclosure of the requested records will therefore fill a clear gap in public understanding of how these acquisition decisions are made. I am an independent data journalist, and the requested information will be used for public-facing reporting and analysis.

My work focuses on federal acquisition and contracting practices and is published through Project Salt Box, a platform that regularly produces reporting and analysis intended to inform the public about government procurement activities. Prior reporting has examined ICE's use of real estate acquisitions, contracting vehicles, and associated costs.

The requested records will contribute meaningfully to public understanding of government operations by clarifying how taxpayer funds are being used in these transactions, including the role of private contractors, valuation methodologies, and pricing decisions. This includes informing the public as to whether federal agencies are adhering to standard valuation practices or deviating from them in ways that affect public expenditures.

The information will be disseminated to a broad audience through published reporting and analysis, free of charge. Accordingly, disclosure of the requested information is in the public

interest because it is likely to contribute significantly to public understanding of government operations and activities and is not primarily in my commercial interest.

Expedited Processing Status: Pending Decision

Expedited Processing Justification:

I request expedited processing of this request pursuant to 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(6)(E) because there is a compelling need to inform the public about ongoing federal government activity. The requested records relate to DHS and ICE's acquisition of large-scale warehouse properties for detention and enforcement use, activities that are currently ongoing and the subject of active litigation, public reporting, and government oversight. Several of the properties identified in this request have been the focus of recent legal challenges and time-sensitive policy decisions, including court-ordered reviews and disputes over the use and development of these facilities. There is an urgent need to inform the public about how these acquisitions are being priced and evaluated while decisions about their use, funding, and development are still being made.

Delayed disclosure would limit the public's ability to understand and assess government actions that are actively unfolding. I am an independent journalist covering federal acquisition and contracting practices, and I intend to use the requested information for timely public-facing reporting and analysis. My work is published through Project Salt Box, which regularly reports on DHS and ICE procurement activities. The requested records will be used to inform near-term reporting on these acquisitions and related policy and legal developments. Given the ongoing nature of these activities and the immediate relevance of the requested information to public understanding, expedited processing is warranted.